



iCFD

A Digital Formation Platform for Catholic Faith Defenders

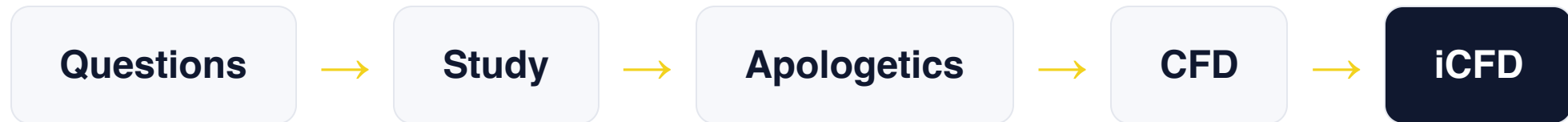
Presented by **Earlrodson Cariño**
Lead Software Architect / Engineering — Catholic Faith Defenders

INTRODUCTION

From Software Engineering to Catholic Apologetics

- Almost **17 years** in software engineering and architecture
- Currently a **Line Manager**
- Experience building software systems and platforms
- Involved in CFD through a personal journey of rediscovering and defending the Catholic faith

This Did Not Begin as a Software Project



THE PROBLEM

The Information Is There. The Connection Is Missing.

There is already a tremendous amount of Catholic information online:

- Bible
- Catechism
- Church documents
- Apologetics
- Theology
- Church Fathers
- Articles and discussions



*Where do I start?
What should I study next?
How are these sources connected?
Can I access them offline?*

But information is often **scattered across different sources.**

Five Problems iCFD Was Built to Address

- Catholic teaching material is **scattered across many disconnected sources** — Bible, Catechism, Church documents, apologetics, theology, Church Fathers.
- Members don't know **where to start or what to study next** — there is no guided path through the material.
- There is no simple way to **evaluate how well a member is actually learning** — formation has no measurable feedback loop.
- Educators and catechists lack a **focused tool to guide members with good content** — most teaching still depends on scattered personal effort.
- Existing material isn't always available **offline or in the member's own language** (Cebuano, Tagalog).

It Started With 12 Questions

My wife gave me a list of **12 topics** she wanted to understand, and asked me to write explanations so she could study them.

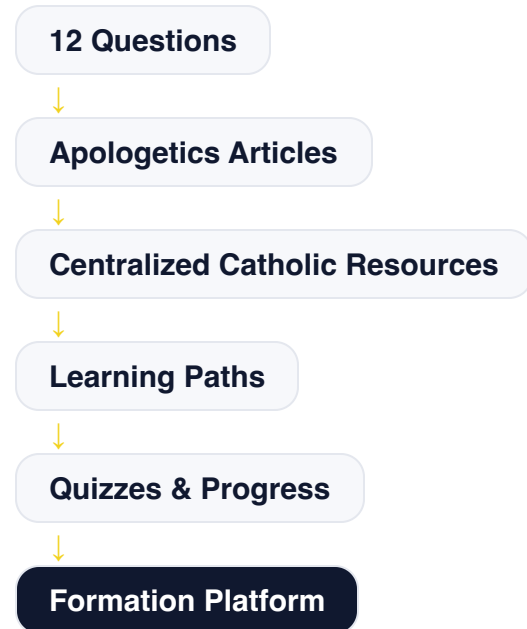
Because Cebuano was difficult for her, I initially created the material in **Tagalog and English**.

"Why stop at 12 articles when I can build something that can become a library?"

That became the beginning of **iCFD**.

FROM ARTICLES TO PLATFORM

The Idea Grew



The goal evolved from simply **providing answers** to helping Catholics **learn, practice, and defend the faith**.

VISION

iCFD

A Digital Apologetics and Formation Companion

iCFD brings together:

Apologetics

Scripture · Catechism · Church Documents

Formation

Church Fathers · theological terminology

Progress

Structured learning · quizzes · certificates

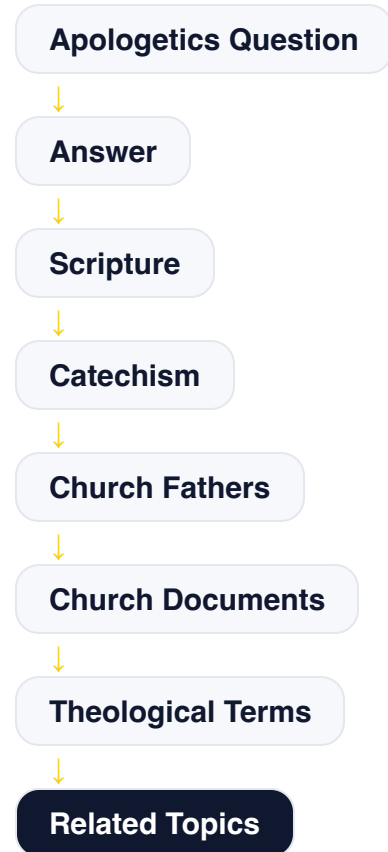
Make Catholic formation easier to access, easier to study, easier to connect, and easier to continue.

Let Me Show You iCFD



The presenter will switch to the live application.

One Question, Many Connections



Implemented — screenshot follows

A Real Topic Page

 **iCFD**
CATHOLIC FAITH DEFENDERS

☰

[← Back to Handbook](#)

● Church Teaching ● Intermediate

Catholic Teaching on Creation and Evolution

"Does the Catholic Church require belief in a six-day creation and reject evolution? Or can a Catholic accept evolutionary science?"

Concise Brief

Aa Logos Fides

"In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth." — Genesis 1:1

The Catholic Church does not require literal six-day creationism, nor does it condemn evolutionary biology. It teaches that God is the Creator of everything that exists, that the universe is not the product of chance but of divine intelligence and will, and that the human soul is directly created by God. Within these theological convictions, the Church allows wide latitude

Implemented

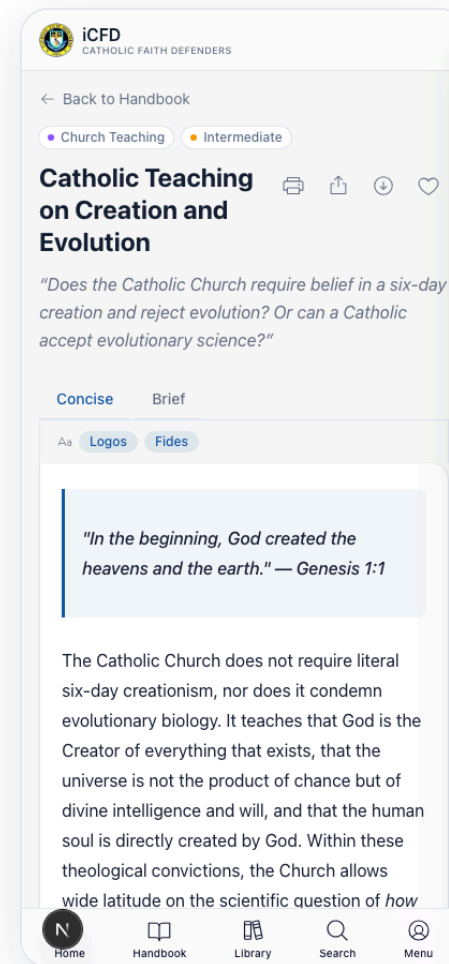
Formation Should Not Depend on Internet Access

iCFD is built as a **Progressive Web App (PWA)** with real offline capability — service worker caching, installable icon set, offline content access.

Live demo:

1. Load content
2. Disable internet
3. Open previously downloaded content
4. Continue reading

Implemented



Reading Is Not the Same as Formation

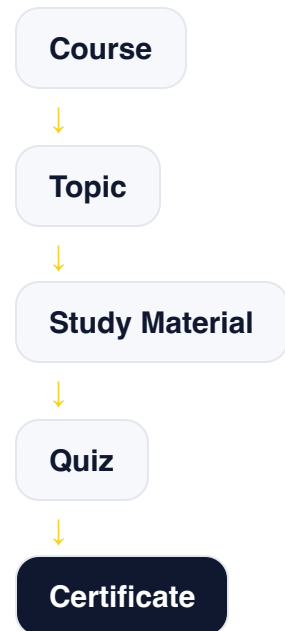
- Learning Paths
- Course progression
- Topic completion
- Quizzes
- Passing thresholds
- Progress tracking
- Certificates



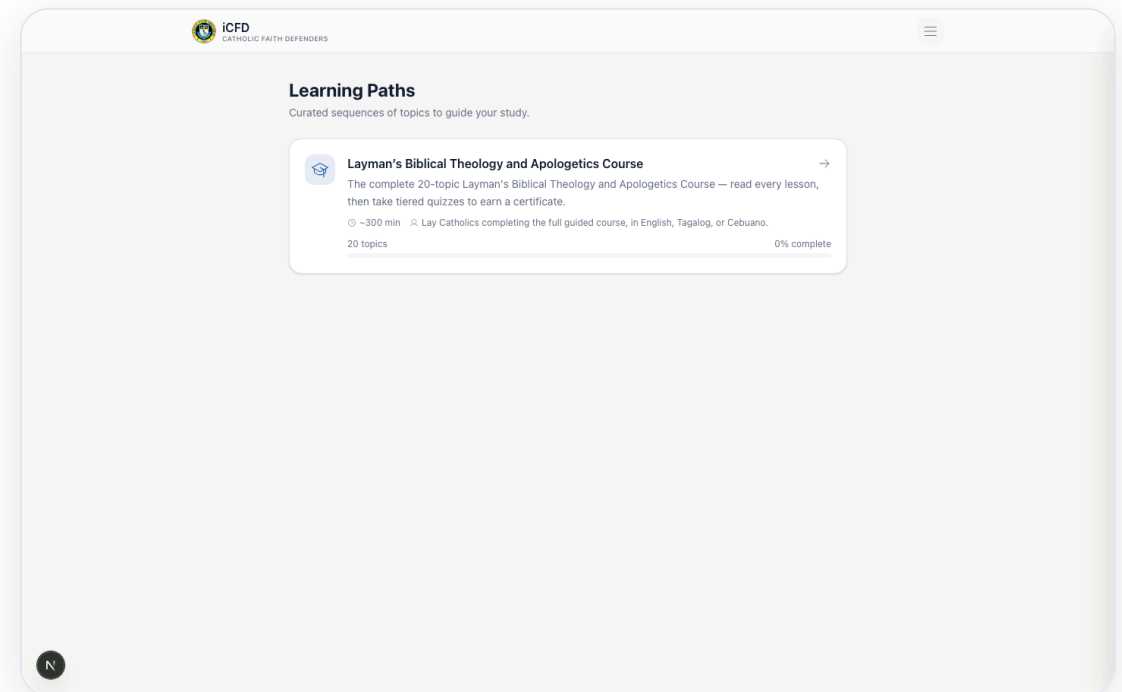
Implemented end-to-end — quiz completion auto-issues a certificate

Bringing CFD Formation Into a Digital Experience

The **CFD Layman's Biblical Theology and Apologetics Course** provides a structured formation framework with **20 themes/topics**.



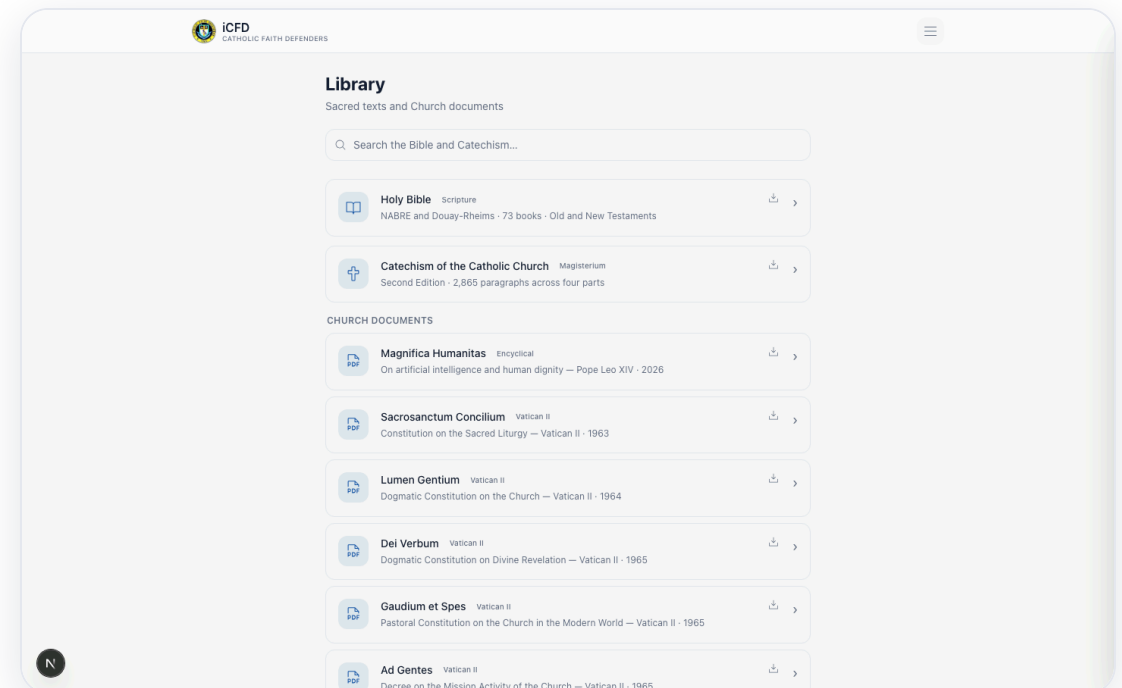
The complete question bank is still being developed. This course is live in the product, but not every topic yet has a full quiz bank.



A Central Place to Find the Sources

- **Holy Bible** — NABRE & Douay-Rheims
- **Catechism of the Catholic Church** — 2,865 paragraphs
- **Church documents** — Vatican II constitutions & encyclicals
- **General Instruction of the Roman Missal**
- **Code of Canon Law**
- **Church Fathers** & apologetics topics

The goal is to connect sources to the topics being studied.



Sometimes the Meaning Is in the Word



ekklesia

Greek → assembly, called-out ones → "Church"

latria

Worship due to God alone

dulia

Veneration given to saints

Theotokos

"God-bearer" — title of Mary

kecharitomene

"Full of grace" — Luke 1:28

The objective is to help the defender understand terminology behind theological arguments — not merely memorize conclusions.

From Personal Study to CFD Formation

The platform can support:

- CFD members & formation materials
- Presentations & apologetics resources
- Learning paths & certificates
- User progress & administrative content management



Partially implemented — foundations built, org-wide rollout is a direction, not a current state

If We Care About Formation, We Need Visibility

- User management
- Topic & reference management
- Learning paths & quiz management
- Certificates
- Presentations
- Activity & learning analytics

Implemented

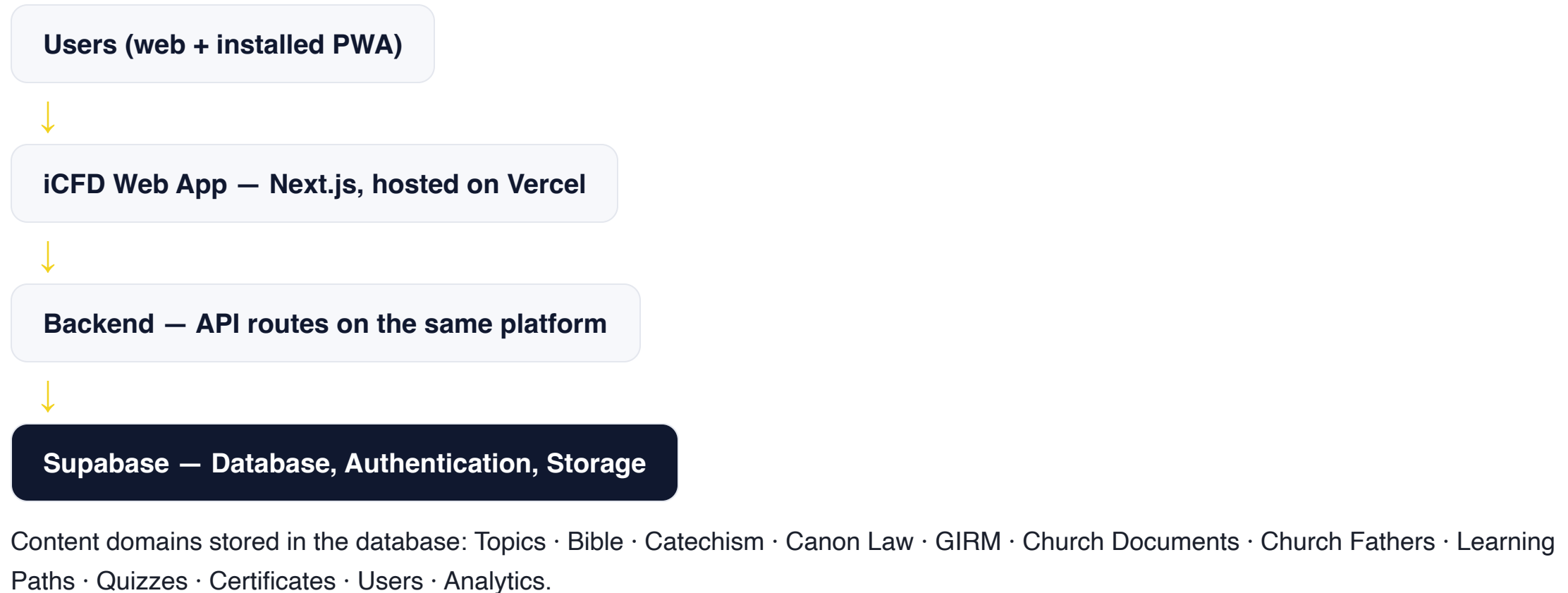
Geo-analytics dashboard: in active development

What are members studying? Which topics are being completed? Where are learners struggling? Which materials are actually being used?

The objective is formation insight, not surveillance.

CURRENT ARCHITECTURE

How iCFD Works



Designed to Start Small and Scale With Evidence

- Cloud-hosted, managed infrastructure — no servers to maintain ourselves
- Progressive Web App — one codebase, works on any device, installable
- Centralized database with authentication and file storage
- Offline-capable client
- Infrastructure that scales up only when usage requires it

Do not pay for capacity we do not yet need.

What Does It Cost Today?

Service	Current Plan	Cost
Vercel (hosting)	Free tier	₹0
Supabase (database, auth, storage)	Free tier	₹0
Domain	[INSERT CURRENT DOMAIN COST]	[INSERT ₹/year]
Other services	[INSERT IF ANY]	[INSERT ₹]
Total recurring		[INSERT ₹X]

The current deployment intentionally operates within free-tier infrastructure, appropriate for the current pilot and user base.

We Upgrade Based on Usage — Not the Calendar

Capacity

Database/storage limits · Bandwidth · Function limits

Usage

Growing users · Concurrent usage · Increasing traffic

Reliability

Backup requirements · Monitoring · Availability

Product growth

Larger content library · Advanced analytics

Organization

Additional organizational features

Scale when the evidence says we need to scale.

Scaling the Platform



STAGE 1 — CURRENT

Pilot

- Free/low-cost infrastructure
- Validate concept
- Build content
- Measure adoption

STAGE 2

CFD Davao

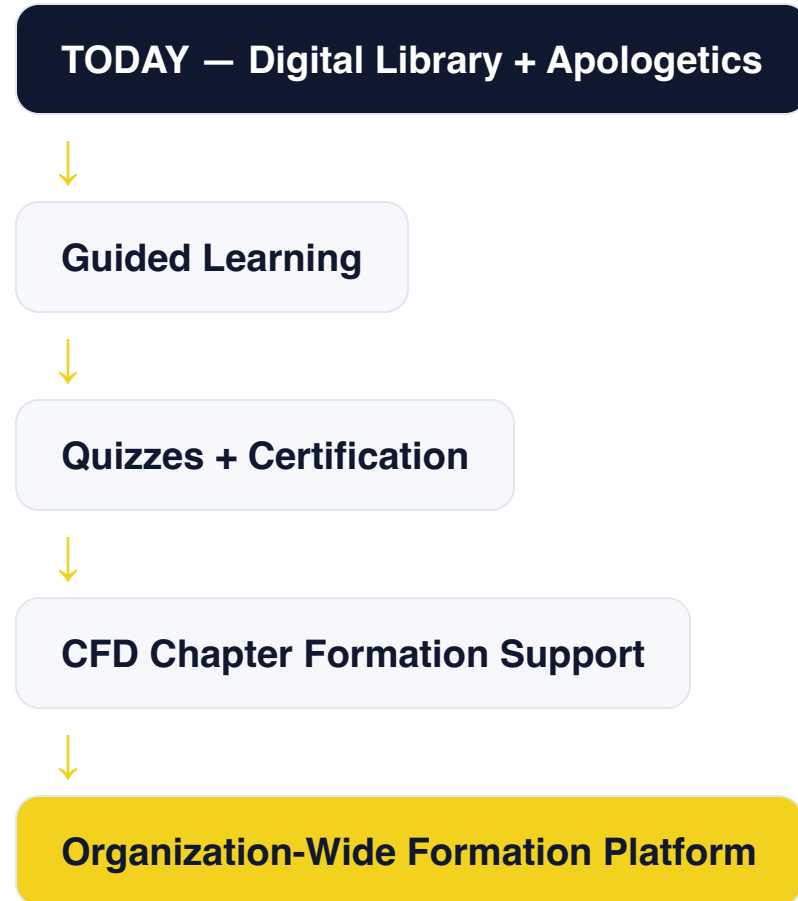
- More users
- More content
- More learning activity
- Paid infrastructure where required

STAGE 3

Organization-Wide

- Larger user base
- Higher reliability requirements
- More advanced administration
- Infrastructure becomes an organizational investment

Where iCFD Goes From Here



Everything below "Today" is described as a **planned direction**, not an existing feature.

iCFD Does Not Replace the Church



It does not replace:

Priests

Catechists

CFD leaders

Personal formation

Parish communities

The Magisterium

Technology should serve formation — not replace it.

iCFD is a tool for formation and access to Catholic resources. It does not replace the teaching authority of the Church or formation provided by priests, catechists, and CFD leaders.

A Tool to Support Our Educators

iCFD gives our educators a focused way to bring good, guided content to CFD members — a new way of teaching, not a replacement for it.

It also gives us something we've never had: a simple, data-driven way to see how well members are actually learning.

I would now like to open the floor for questions, recommendations, and guidance from the Board.